CHAPTER 3 · PULSE & COUNTING

Lesson Book draft v1 + review pack

Built on your own words for the pulse: **"Music has a heartbeat: the pulse. It keeps going, steady, even when the notes stop."** It keeps to the level plan's scope for room 3 (a steady beat, counting out loud, the beat and the rhythm are not the same, with clapped words) and uses the cast of chapters 1 and 2: the sister and the brother, the small house and the big house, the bird, the turtle and the lighthouse. Chapter 3 comes before the letter names, so the keys are named by their house and the fingers by their numbers. It follows the Book rules: one idea per page, set tasks, nothing twice, and no "--".

AMEB: the pulse is practical work, with no paper question at Preliminary; it is the groundwork for 2/4 and 3/4 (Preliminary), which come with Time Signatures (room 8).

The draft, 7 pages: 1 the heart and its steady beat (opener) · 2 A steady beat: the same gap every time (footprints) · 3 Count out loud: 1 2 3 4, then back to 1 (the brother, a counting ring) · 4 When the notes stop: silent beats still count · 5 Beat or rhythm? bird and tur-tle over four beats · 6 The pulse in your fingers: a new finger on each beat, on the black-key houses · 7 My five checks.

How to answer: reply with codes, e.g. "B3 no, B7 yes, G3 none". The yellow marks in the draft (B3, B7) show the lines that wait for your answers.

Three questions for the public guide page

G1	When your students meet the pulse, what goes wrong most often? (My guesses: speeding up; stopping the count on a long note or a silence; clapping the words instead of the beat; counting in their head instead of out loud.)
G2	Is there anything you always say or do for a steady beat in a lesson (a heartbeat, walking, a clock, a metronome) that the page should catch?
G3	A tip for parents, or none, as for chapter 11?

What's in this pack

A · what today's chapter 3 does · B · your decisions, each with my recommendation · the 7 draft pages · today's online lesson and Workbook, for comparison.

A · What today's chapter 3 does

Today chapter 3 is an online lesson in six steps, a drill with 2 levels, and a Workbook and Teacher copy made before the Book rules. There is no Lesson Book yet.

A1	The online lesson is cards and tools in six steps, not a Lesson Book on screen. After your OK it becomes the book on screen, like chapters 1, 2, 4, 6, 7, 11 and 15.
A2	It teaches more than the pulse: strong and weak beats (room 8); crotchets, minims, dotted minims, semibreves and quavers with "1 and" (room 5); bars of 4/4 and rhythm cards (rooms 8 and 14); 2/4, 3/4 and 6/8 in "Tap the right beat" (room 8).
A3	It has a song inside the chapter: "Hot Cross Buns". Your rule: no songs inside the chapters.
A4	The drill does not test the pulse. Level 1 asks how many beats a note lasts; level 2 asks which bar you heard. Both need note values and bars first.
A5	The Workbook and Teacher copy came before the Book rules: a map page, a drill page, a "Heartbeat hunt" (find and draw anything), a task with a song on the radio and "a friend's card", note-value and strong/weak pages, and a scored check-up.
A6	The tempo readout "72 beats a minute" stays on screen as a setting; the book does not teach speed.

Checked by a second reviewer

A separate reviewer checked every page in English and Korean against the scope and the Book rules. The scope held, the fingerings fit the houses, and the syllable splits were right. I applied these fixes from its list:

- The little quaver next to the bird is gone: it is a note value, which comes in chapter 5.
- Page 6: the finger numbers sit in coral circles and the count is plain numbers, so a child never reads a finger as a count. The page now says "a new finger on each beat", because page 3 already plays one note on each beat.
- Every piano task names the hand, the finger and the house: the 4th small house; the big house next to it; the 3rd small house for the left hand. The rows say "play the row twice".
- Page 2: the footprints walk to the right, left foot and right foot, and the gaps in "not steady" are really uneven.
- Page 4: "lift your hand", "just above the key" (not in your lap), "Then you come back in at the right time"; bigger circles in two groups of four.
- The 1 on page 3 is navy, not coral: a coral 1 could read as a strong beat, which waits for room 8.
- Korean: 무릎을 치며 꾸준한 박을 지킬 수 있어요; 간격이 매번 똑같아요; 발로 바닥을 톡톡 치며; 낱말 소리마다 손뼉을 쳐요; 조용한 박에서도 계속 세요.

B · Your decisions

B1 The pictures: your heart on the opener; the beat as a row of circles (as in the finger tunes of chapters 1 and 2); footprints for "steady". **Rec** yes.

B2 Words: "pulse" in the title and on the opener, "beat" everywhere else (for a beginner they are the same thing). Korean 박 for both. **Rec** yes.

B3 Speed: page 2 ends with "Then 8 more, slower, still steady." Speed belongs to Tempo (room 13), and "slower" right after "the gaps change = not steady" can confuse. **Rec** no: take the line out, steady only.

B4 Strong and weak beats (the 1 louder; pat on 1, clap the rest) move to Time Signatures (room 8), as the level plan says. Today's step 3 goes there. **Rec** yes.

B5 Counting here is only 1 2 3 4, round and round: no "and" (the quaver pair comes in room 5), no counting in 2s or 3s (2/4 and 3/4 come in room 8). **Rec** yes.

B6 Silent beats: page 4 says "silent beats still count", drawn as a dashed circle. No rest sign and no rest name yet (rests come in room 5). **Rec** yes.

B7 Beat or rhythm, with words from the cast: bird (one sound), tur-tle (two), light-house (two); Korean 새, 거-북, 등-대. It replaces "Hot Cross Buns". Other word sets are possible (fruit, names). **Rec** yes.

B8 Page 6: finger numbers in coral circles everywhere in this chapter; the count in white circles or plain numbers. **Rec** yes.

B9 The drill, 5 levels: 1 steady or not? (listen) · 2 tap along: 8 taps with the click, the app draws your gaps · 3 keep it going: the click stops after 4, tap 4 more alone · 4 count inside: count 1 2 3 4 and tap only on the beat it names (today's "Tap the right beat", 4 beats only) · 5 beat or rhythm? (words over a beat: tap the beat, not the words). Today's two levels move to rooms 5 and 8. **Rec** these 5.

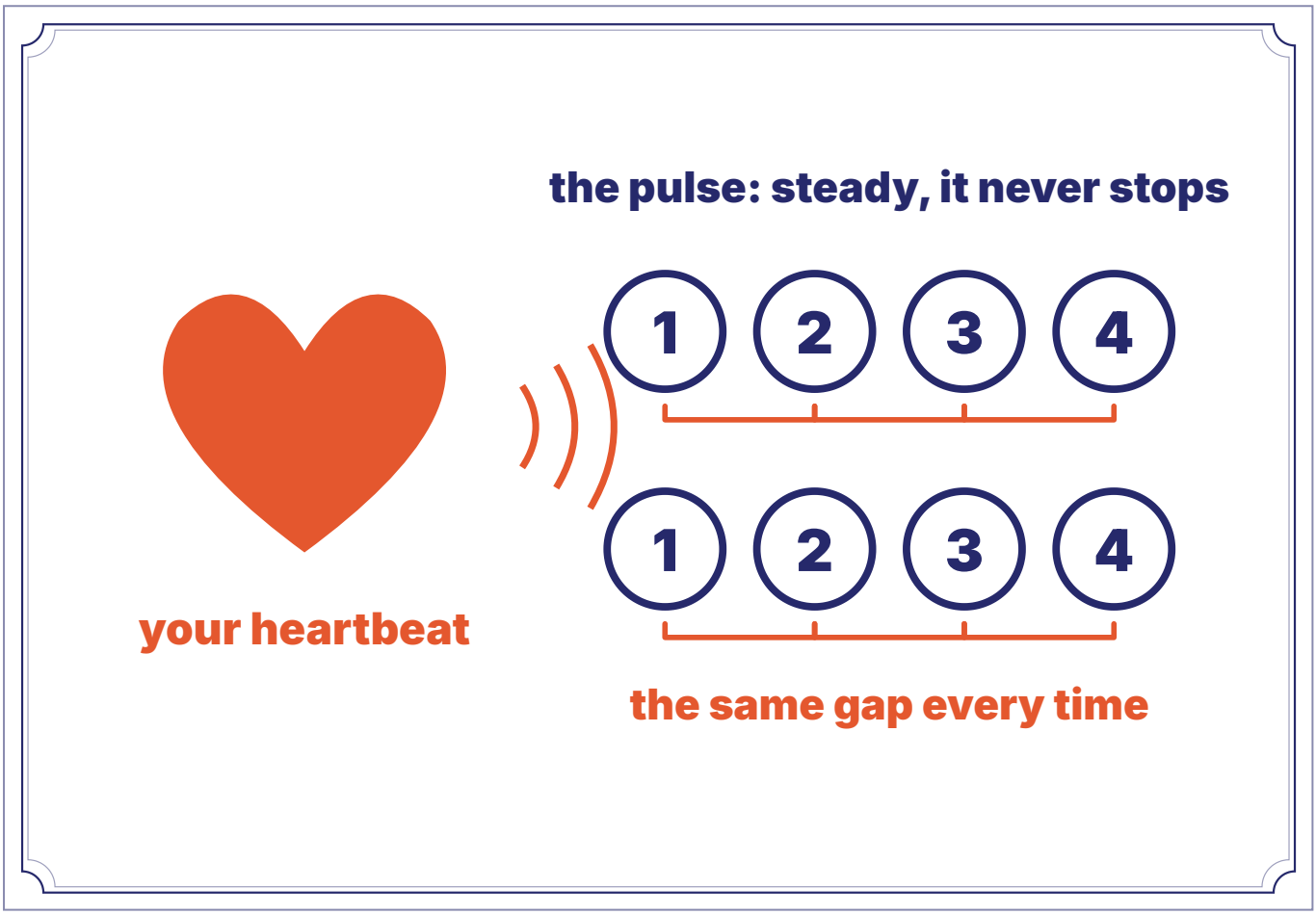
B10 Workbook ideas, set tasks a child does alone (built after the book): W1 steady or not: circle the footprint trails with the same gaps · W2 number the beats: write 1 2 3 4 in a long row of circles · W3 silent beats: write the count in every circle, colour the ones you play · W4 beat or rhythm: under printed words, one dot for each sound · W5 the finger beat: write the finger numbers for a set pattern over the count · last page: the check-up on paper. **Rec** all six.

B11 On screen (the book on screen, what moves): page 2 a steady click with a tap pad that draws your gaps; page 3 the counting ring lights up with the click; page 4 play and silent circles to tap; page 5 the words over a beat, tap the beat, then the words; page 6 tap the black keys with the count. **Rec** yes.

CHAPTER 3

Pulse & Counting

Music has a heartbeat: the **pulse**. It keeps going, steady, with **the same gap every time**, even when the notes stop. In this chapter you feel it, count it out loud, and keep it going at the piano.



In this chapter

- ☐ A steady beat 2
- ☐ Count out loud 3
- ☐ When the notes stop 4
- ☐ Beat or rhythm? 5
- ☐ The pulse in your fingers 6
- ☐ My five checks 7

By the end, you can

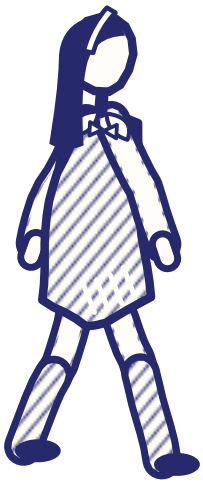
- ☐ pat a steady beat, the same gap every time
- ☐ count out loud, 1 2 3 4, while you pat
- ☐ keep counting through silent beats
- ☐ tell the beat from the rhythm
- ☐ play a new finger on each beat and count out loud

online

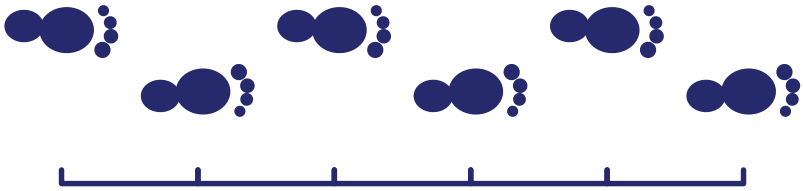
STEP 1

A steady beat

A **steady beat** has **the same gap every time**, like your heartbeat, a ticking clock, or your feet when you walk. Not steady means the gaps change: faster, slower, stop, go. The pulse of music is steady.



✔ steady



the same gap every time

× not steady



At the piano

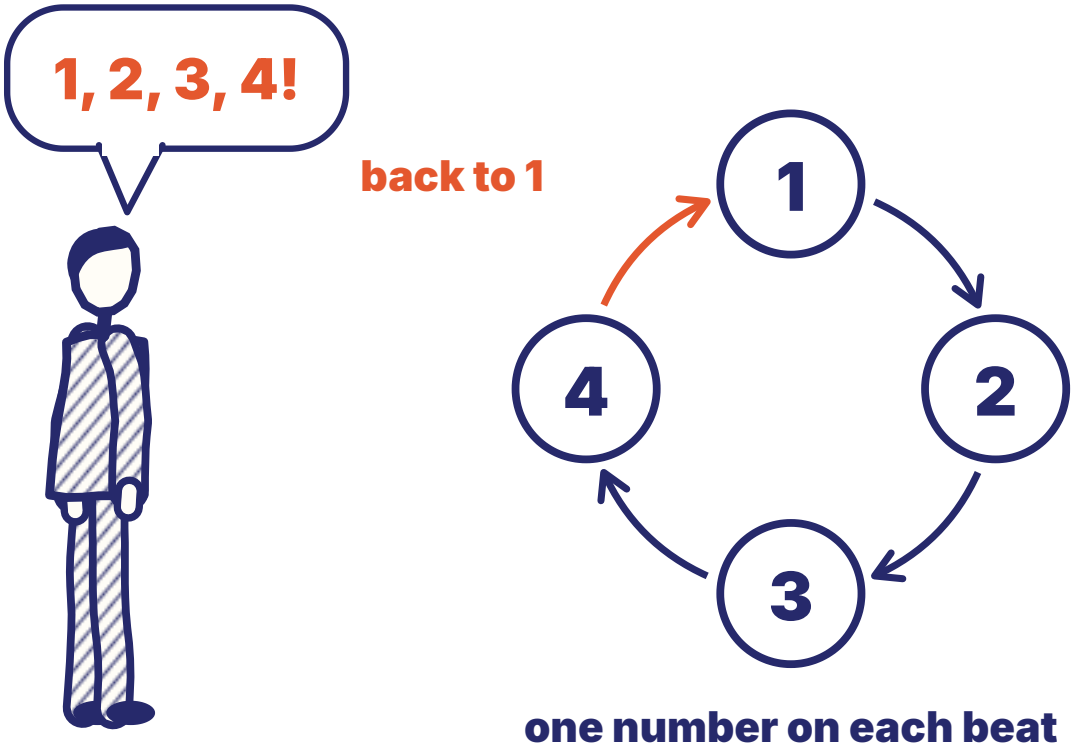
1. Pat your knees with both hands, 8 times, steady: the same gap every time, like a clock. ☐
2. Walk 8 steps across the room: one step on each beat, the same gap every time. Then 8 more, slower, still steady. B3 ☐

REMEMBER **A steady beat: the same gap every time.**

STEP 2

Count out loud

Give every beat a number: **1 2 3 4**, then start again at 1. Say it out loud, one number on each beat, not faster and not slower. Counting out loud keeps the beat steady, and later it tells you where every note goes.



At the piano

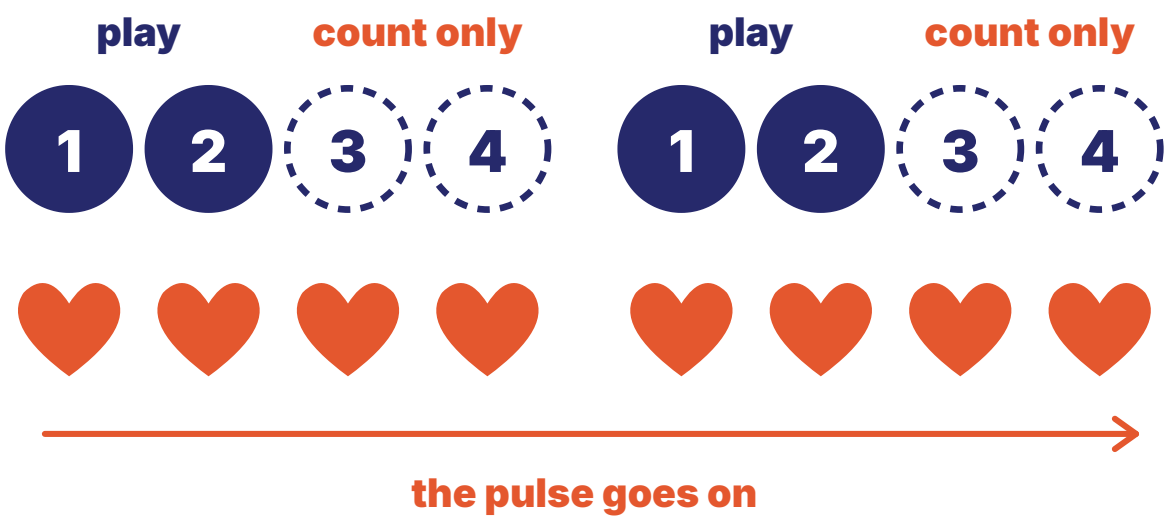
1. Pat your knees and count out loud: 1 2 3 4, four times round, without stopping. ☐
2. Right hand: finger 3 on the right black key of the 4th small house. Play it on every beat and count: 1 2 3 4, four times round. ☐

REMEMBER **Count out loud: 1 2 3 4, then 1 again.**

STEP 3

When the notes stop

The pulse does not stop when you stop playing. Play on 1 and 2, lift your hand on 3 and 4, and keep counting: **the silent beats still count.** Then you come back in at the right time.



At the piano

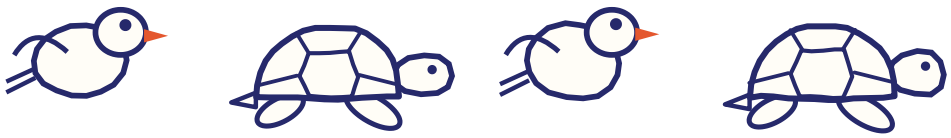
1. Right hand, finger 3 on the right black key of the 4th small house: play on 1 and 2, lift on 3 and 4, and keep counting out loud. Four times round. ☐
2. Now play only on 1, and count 2 3 4 with your hand just above the key. Four times round. ☐

REMEMBER **Silent beats still count.**

STEP 4

Beat or rhythm?

The **beat** is the steady pulse underneath. The **rhythm** is the pattern of sounds on top, long and short, like the sounds of words. [B7] Say **bird** on one beat: one sound. Say **tur-tle** on one beat: two sounds. The beat stays the same; the rhythm changes.



	bird	tur-tle	bird	tur-tle
rhythm the sounds	●	● ●	●	● ●
beat steady	♥	♥	♥	♥

At the piano

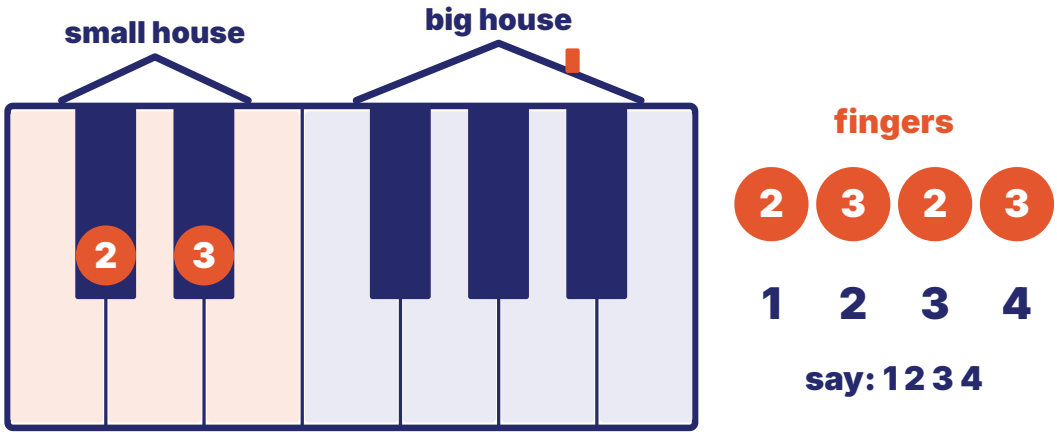
1. Tap the beat with your foot and say: bird, tur-tle, bird, tur-tle, one word on each beat. Then clap the words while your foot keeps the beat. ☐
2. Now: tur-tle, tur-tle, bird, bird. And: light-house, bird, light-house, bird. ☐

REMEMBER **The beat stays steady; the rhythm is the sounds on top.**

STEP 5

The pulse in your fingers

Now your fingers take turns: a new finger on each beat. Count out loud as you play: 1 2 3 4. The numbers in the coral circles are finger numbers.



Small-house beat

right hand, fingers 2 and 3 on the 4th small house; play the row twice, counting 1 2 3 4

2 3 2 3 2 3 2 3

Big-house beat

right hand, fingers 2 3 4 on the big house next to it; play the row twice, counting 1 2 3 4

2 3 4 3 2 3 4 3

Left-hand beat

left hand, fingers 3 and 2 on the 3rd small house; play the row twice, counting 1 2 3 4

3 2 3 2 3 2 3 2

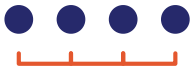
REMEMBER **A new finger on each beat; keep counting.**

CHECK-UP

My five checks

Show each one at the piano, then tick how it is going: not yet, nearly, or got it! The check-up on paper is in the Workbook.

At the piano

	NOT YET	NEARLY	GOT IT!
 **I can pat a steady beat: the same gap every time**	○	◑	☆
 **I can count out loud, 1 2 3 4, while I pat**	○	◑	☆
 **I can keep counting through silent beats**	○	◑	☆
 **I can tell the beat from the rhythm: my foot keeps the beat, my hands clap the words**	○	◑	☆
 **I can play a new finger on each beat and count out loud**	○	◑	☆

Colour a circle each time it gets better: not yet, then nearly, then got it!

Today's online lesson and Workbook, for comparison

The six steps today: feel the pulse; beat or rhythm ("Hot Cross Buns"); strong and weak beats; tap the right beat (2/4, 3/4, 4/4, 6/8); count out loud with note values; clap the rhythm cards. Below: the first step on screen, and two of today's Workbook pages.



